

INTERNATIONAL news

Renesas acquires Panthronics to extend connectivity portfolio with NFC

A wholly-owned subsidiary of Renesas Electronics Corporation has entered into a definitive agreement with the shareholders of Panthronics AG. Panthronics is a fabless semiconductor company specialising in high-performance wireless products, under which Renesas will acquire Panthronics in an all-cash transaction. Renesas believes that NFC has emerged as a de facto standard in the digital economy and touches many aspects of daily life and the acquisition will enrich its portfolio of connectivity technology, extending its reach into high-demand Near-Field Communication (NFC) applications in fintech, IoT, asset tracking, wireless charging, and automotive applications. It is noteworthy that the two companies have been partnering since 2018 to address the rising demand for NFC.

China to offer subsidy to top domestic chip makers

China is easing access to its chip subsidy to a few of its top semiconductor manufacturers and providing more control over state-backed research and development. Its latest policy comes after the US enforced its CHIPS and Science Act last year in August. Various media reported that chipmakers such as Semiconductor Manufacturing International (SMIC), Hua Hong Semiconductor, and Huawei, as well as equipment suppliers like Naura and Advanced Micro-Fabrication Equipment Inc China could benefit from the policy. China's move will allow the selected companies to have more access to government funding for domestic chip equipment.

Infineon and Delta Electronics forge partnership on electromobility

Leading automotive semiconductors player Infineon Technologies AG and Taiwan based power and energy management company Delta Electronics, Inc. recently announced that they are expanding their long-term cooperation from industrial to automotive applications.

In this regard, both companies signed an MoU to deepen their joint innovation activities aimed at providing more efficient and higher-density solutions for the fast-growing market of electric vehicles (EVs). As per the official note, the agreement covers a wide range of components, such as high-voltage and low-voltage discrete and modules as well as microcontrollers to be used in EV drivetrain applications that include traction inverters, DC-DC converters, and on-board chargers.



Foxconn reports mixed results, net profits fall by 10%

Apple's supplier Hon Hai Precision Technology (Foxconn) has reported mixed results, beating analysts' estimates on the topline but reporting a 10% year-on-year decline on the bottom line. The Taiwanese contract manufacturer said revenue in the first quarter of FY24 rose 3.9% year-on-year to \$74.14 billion (511.85 billion Chinese yuan) for the full year, beating market estimates. Foxconn warned the outlook for the second quarter was likely to fall on a quarter-on-quarter and year-on-year basis. In its earnings report, the company anticipated declining consumer electronics demand for the full year ahead.

Foxconn to invest \$820 million in EV plant in Taiwan

Taiwanese electronics contract manufacturer Hon Hai Precision Technology (Foxconn) will invest \$820 million over the next three years to build a new manufacturing facility in Kaohsiung, southern Taiwan, as it looks at venturing into the electric vehicles (EVs) sector. The proposed facility will reportedly have plants for making electric buses and batteries for EVs. Taiwan intends to become a major player in the EV industry, with the government providing incentives to attract investment and support the development of local talent in the field. Apart from Taiwan, it has also partnered with companies in Thailand and Saudi Arabia.

Continental and Infineon to build high-performing vehicle architecture

Leading tech company Continental announced its collaboration with Infineon Technologies AG in the development of server based vehicle architectures. The partners said that the goal is to build an organised and efficient electronics/electronics (E/E) architecture with central high-performance computers (HPCs) and a few, powerful zone control units (ZCUs). This will be different from the earlier versions, where up to a hundred or even more individual control units used to be present. It is learnt that Continental has started using Infineon's AURIX TC4 microcontroller for its ZCU platform. The partners further claimed that RRAM (Resistive Random Access Memory) technology is being applied in the automotive sector for the first time.

Electreon, Toyota, Denso partner to develop wireless EV charging systems

Israeli startup Electreon has inked a pact with Japanese automaker Toyota Motors and global auto parts manufacturer Denso Corporation to develop a vehicle receiver based on Electreon's wireless EV charging technology for Toyota's electric vehicles (EVs). The companies held a successful demonstration of wireless charging Toyota's RAV4-PHEV on the road. It is learnt that the companies are currently discussing a joint development agreement to create an aftermarket wireless kit for current electrified models like the Toyota RAV4 Prime, integration of the wireless charging technology into new vehicles, and a joint pilot project.

Würth Elektronik subsidiary opens in Baltics

In the latest update from Lithuania, a new subsidiary of Würth Elektronik has been registered there. Würth is originally a German manufacturer of electronic and electromechanical components. Named Würth Elektronik Lietuva, UAB, the subsidiary has been formed by seven Lithuanian employees of the company. The company claims to have found customers for Würth Elektronik's complete portfolio in the Baltic branch. The region boasts a number of manufacturers in areas such as wireless technology, fleet management systems, power electronics for lasers, and building automation.

Nexperia's energy harvesting PMIC powers eco-friendly low-power devices

In order to make and improve the performance of low-power Internet of Things (IoT) and other embedded applications, Nexperia recently revealed the expansion of its line of power ICs with energy harvesting solutions. The NEH2000BY is a high-performance power management integrated circuit (PMIC) that uses energy gathered from ambient sources like light to replenish a battery or storage capacitor. As a consequence, Nexperia's NEH2000BY will make it possible to create self-powered, compact, and environmentally friendly electronic devices. The annual production and disposal of billions of batteries can be lessened with the aid of this energy harvesting option.